

ALL SLAVES SHALL BE HELD TO BE REAL ESTATE

SLAVE CODES (1661–18TH CENTURY)



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Law codes, slavery

BEFORE

1619 The first African slaves are landed in North America, in the colony of Virginia.

AFTER

1865 Slavery ends in the United States but is replaced with the “black codes.”

1954 The US Supreme Court declares that school segregation on racial grounds is unconstitutional.

2000 Alabama is the last state to lift the ban on interracial marriage.

2013 The US Supreme Court overturns the last remaining restrictions on African American voting rights.

A year before the *Mayflower* carried 102 colonists from England to New England in 1620, a Dutch ship, the *White Lion*, landed farther south at Point Comfort, Virginia. Onboard were 20 African slaves, the first to arrive in North America. By the end of the century, more than 20,000 slaves had been imported, and by the time of the US Declaration of Independence in 1776, the slave population was nearly half a million.

Many Europeans had come to America to find freedom and make a new start. Others were there to exploit the profits to be made from growing crops such as tobacco, rice, and indigo. The harvesting and processing of these crops required labor on a large scale,